

connect to a server over the internet to make commits. This makes Git fast and available to work with when you're offline.

From a terminal, run the following commands to create the *.git* folder. (On macOS and Linux, you'll need to run `mkdir` instead of `md`.)

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```
C:\Users\Al>md wizcoin
C:\Users\Al>cd wizcoin
C:\Users\Al\wizcoin>git init
Initialized empty Git repository in C:/Users/Al/wizcoin/.git/
```

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When you convert a folder into a Git repo by running `git init`, all the files in it start as untracked. For our *wizcoin* folder, the `git init` command creates the *wizcoin/.git* folder, which contains the Git repo metadata. The presence of this *.git* folder makes a folder a Git repository; without it, you simply have a collection of source code files in an ordinary folder. You'll never have to directly modify the files in *.git*, so just ignore this folder. In fact, it's named *.git* because most operating systems automatically hide folders and files whose names begin with a period.

Now you have a repo in your *C:\Users\Al\wizcoin* working directory. A repo on your computer is known as a *local repo*; a repo located on someone else's computer is known as a *remote repo*. This distinction is important, because you'll often have to share commits between local and remote repos so you can work with other developers on the same project.

You can now use the `git` command to add files and track changes within the working directory. If you run `git status` in your newly created repo, you'll see the following:

---

```
C:\Users\Al\wizcoin>git status
On branch master

No commits yet

nothing to commit (create/copy files and use "git add" to track)
```

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The output from this command informs you that you have no commits yet in this repo.